Design Document: Connecting Prototypes to Lecture Concepts and Client Requirements

Client: AIDS Program South Saskatchewan (APSS)

Introduction:

This document will connect the design of our WordPress website prototype for the AIDS Program South Saskatchewan (APSS) with the learning concepts from the ENSE 271 lectures and the client's needs.

The analysis of the client's needs is noted in the Empathy map, and the design ideas from our group are represented through the Site Map, Lo-Fi Design prototypes and the Hi-fi prototypes, which were presented to the client. After receiving valuable feedback, we will demonstrate how our current WordPress website prototype applies the client's critiques using topics we have learned through the lectures.

Discussion of Lecture Concepts and Prototype Connections

(Bijay, Renzo, Juanna, Olexiy)

How we addressed ideas and concepts discussed in the lectures for our project conceptualization and work.

The ideas and concepts we have been learning through this course had helped us on each step of our planning and in developing our WordPress website. We have discussed how we related our Low-Fi and Hi-Fi prototypes with major topics such as constraints, affordances and Gestalt, the psychopathology of everyday things and psychology of everyday actions, with experimental approaches of brainstorming designs. Here is how we addressed the key lecture concepts in our project:

1. **Using Constraints**
   We realized that users must be able to easily choose the right decisions instead of getting lost while finding the proper navigation through the website. Constraint plays a vital role in helping us map the right things in the right place, so that the user may get the correct website information. Here is what we practiced:
   - Limited dropdown menus:

- Helps users find information with ease. Through the website's header, users can also find "About Us", "Education", "Get Help" and "Get Involved", which are tabs that gives the user a dropdown menu for quick and easy navigation to their respective pages.



- Research as the main navigation link:
  - We planned to make "Research" a section under "Education", but we changed it to be a separate main navigation link, so that it reduces the frustration for users who are coming for research but cannot easily find it, being that it is in a different page. Therefore, changing "Research" to be a main hotlink solved that problem.

2. **Using Affordances and Gestalt**

We learned that affordances are **visual clues** that tell users what to do, and Gestalt explains **how brains group that visual information**. The APSS's original website has a lot of broken hotlinks with a visual appearance that suggests further information. Our WordPress website is developed with separate information being in different places, which can be accessed through visual suggestions (button) that guides users to the correct page. This is what we added:

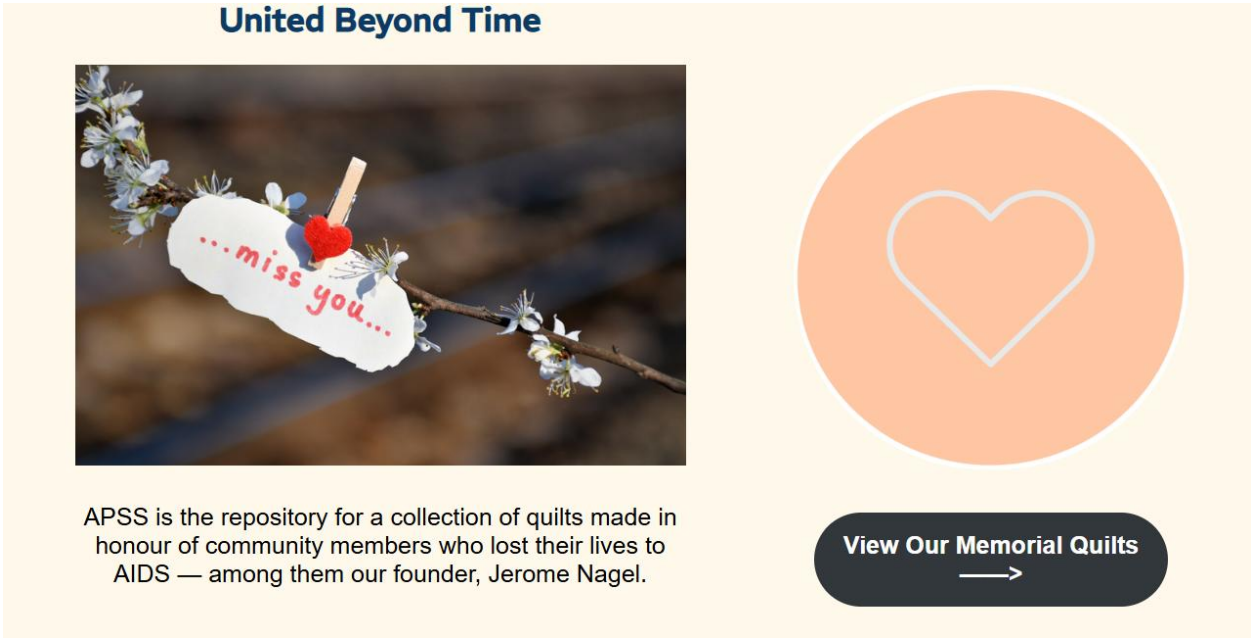


As seen in the Community Care section, "Awareness Drives" and "Support Programs" are designed as rounded rectangle button shapes that tells users to click to see further

information. We added links to their respective information and connected it to these buttons.

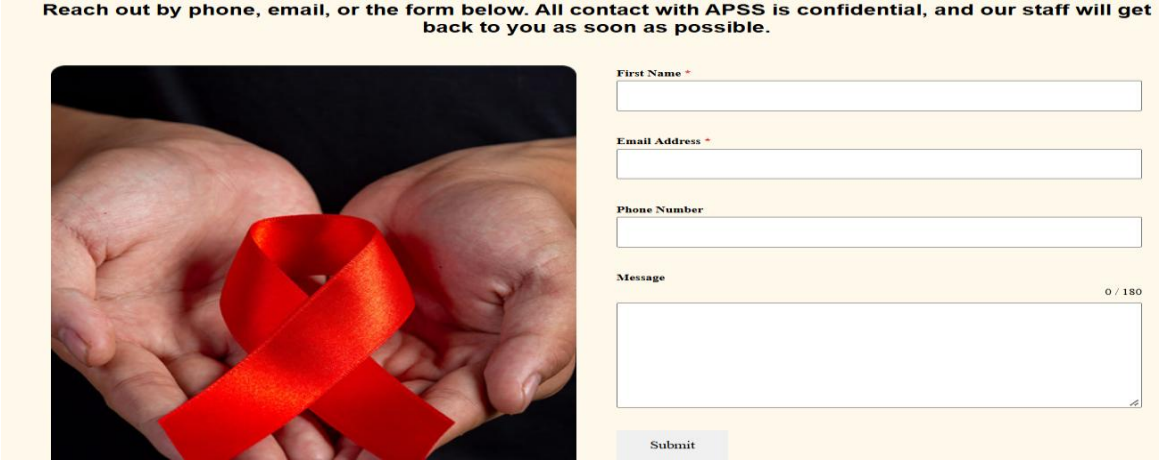


The “Donate” button at the top of the navigation bar helps users easily understand where they can go to support the client’s works.



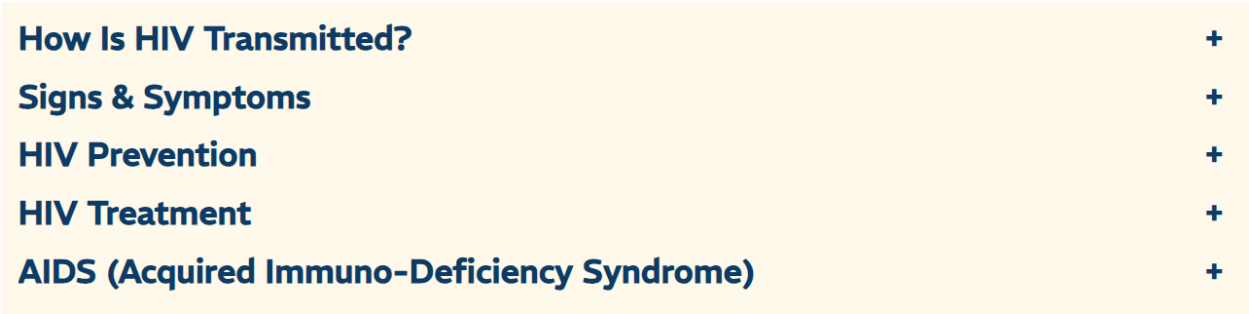
Heart shaped and pointing link visual that guides Users to the APSS memorials quilt page.

3. **Designing For Human Error**
   We learned that **human error is the result of bad design and not the user’s mistakes.** We discussed how to design visuals that can explain what is coming and a way to have less clutter of groupings in the navigation, so that the user can gain more from the website. That helped us think of designs that avoid human error. In our WordPress prototype, we added **forms plugins** that shows users how they can connect with APSS.



We also made sure each links that lead to the information from other websites associated with APSS website **open in other browser windows**, so that the user does not slip (wrong actions) and make mistakes (wrong mental models). These aspects help users avoid accessibility issues.

4. **Solving the Right Problem**
   We learned that finding the right problem and trying to solve that problem heavily matters. The topic of **Root cause Analysis and Double Diamond (the 5 Whys)** really helped us in designing our WordPress prototype. This means finding the root problem before jumping to actual solutions was important. After hearing from our clients that they wanted a visually engaging website, we made sure the website contains images that shows the APSS's works. When we came across text-heavy pages, we used **Accordion blocks** to maintain the pages visual cleanliness while keeping the information readable.



How Is HIV Transmitted?

HIV is transmitted through direct contact with the blood or body fluid of someone who is infected with the virus.

Since November 1985, all blood products in Canada are checked for HIV, to ensure that it is safe to get a blood transfusion. There is no chance of getting HIV from donating blood.

HIV is very fragile and cannot live outside of the body.

- ▶ HIV Can Also Be Passed:
- ▶ HIV Can Only Be Passed By These Five Body Fluids
- ▶ The two main ways that HIV can be passed are:
- ▶ HIV Cannot Be Passed By:

Signs & Symptoms +

HIV Prevention +

HIV Treatment +

AIDS (Acquired Immuno-Deficiency Syndrome) +

We added a video and editable blog posts that encourages users to get engaged with the client's goals and objectives.

Client Story

Below is a client video story. This video tells the story of Charles Redwood's recovery from sexual abuse, addictions, incarceration and HIV to eventual sobriety and dealing with shame. It also details how we managed to help him on his journey to recovery.

It is an inspiring story of courage, faith and dealing with a life's journey that was anything but easy. Charles tells his story simply and in a straightforward manner. It is an inspiring message to us all.





5. **Using Metaphors and Memory**
   We learned that using **familiar concepts (metaphors) and recognition rather than recall helps users** understand the website. These concepts helps users to understand it better, as we do not know who would regularly visit the website. During our conceptualization, we realized that **APSS serves diverse useers like community members, researchers, donors** who may not be **tech savvy**. In our WordPress prototypes, we addressed familiar metaphors like **hearts and "We missed you messages"** before visiting the Memorial Quilts page, which are **people icons** that suggest connected communities. The "**Get Involved" button** uses a universal symbol for website donation, volunteering and careers. These features helped us in our plan to have users understand the website without thinking too hard and in fixing any accessibility issues.







Founded By Gay Men
During The HIV/AIDS Crisis Of 1980s

Proudly serving diverse communities across Southern Saskatchewan today, including First Nations, Metis and Inuit people.